

The description of the language associated with countries mentioned in question is as follows:

(Country)	(Language)
Myanmar	- Burmese
Indonesia	- Indonesian (official language), English, Dutch, Javanese etc .
Mauritius	- English, French (official languages, Hindi, Urdu, Hakka , Bhojpuri and Creole
Singapore	- Malay (National language), English, Mandarin Chinese and Tamil (all official languages).

Thus, Tamil is an official language of Singapore. So, the correct answer would be (d).

6. Given below is a map of America. The shaded (marked 1 and 2), dotted (marked 3) and the plain areas (marked 4) indicate respectively, the regions where the languages spoken are :



- (a) Spanish, French, Portuguese and others
- (b) French, Spanish, Portuguese and others
- (c) French, Portuguese, Spanish and English
- (d) Portuguese, French, Spanish and others

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

In the above map, mark 1 reflects French language (French Guinea); mark 2 Portuguese (Brazil); mark 3 reflects Spanish (Argentina) and mark 4 reflects English. Thus, the correct answer would be option (c).

7. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R).
Assertion (A) : Pakistan has greater racial and ethnic diversity than Bangladesh
Reason (R) : Punjabi is the official language of Pakistan where most people use Urdu language in speaking.

Choose the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false
- (d) (A) is false but (R) is true

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

English and Urdu, are both the official languages of Pakistan. Punjabi is the most widely spoken language, but not an official language. Bangladesh is noted for the ethnic homogeneity of its population.

8. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

(Language)	(Country)
(a) Danish	Denmark
(b) Dutch	Netherlands
(c) Mandarin	China
(d) Bahasa	Thailand

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The correct match is as follows :

Language	Country
Danish	Denmark
Dutch	Netherlands
Mandarin	China
Bahasa	Indonesia

Economic Geography

A. Agriculture & Livestock

Grains are the main source of food for humankind. The important grains are Rice, Wheat, Corn, Millet, Barley, Chickpea, and Pulses etc. * Rice is a plant of the wet tropical climate. Hence rice is grown in most of the wet humid areas of the world, although it can be grown in arid regions also with the help of irrigation. In most areas around the world, rice is grown as a Kharif crop, which is harvested in Nov.-Dec., but in Java, it is harvested in April-May. The **International Rice Gene Bank**, maintained by **International Rice Research Institute (IRRI)** is located in Los Banos (Philippines). IRRI was established in the year 1960. Paddy is very famous in China. Out of the total area under rice cultivation in China half is used to cultivate hybrid rice.

*According to FAO, 2023 India has the maximum area under rice cultivation (47.83 million hectare) followed by China (29.17 million hectare). Despite having less area under rice cultivation, China has a total area under irrigation whereas in India only half of the area under rice cultivation is irrigated. According to Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) 2023 the four leading producers of rice in the world are - 1. China (208.06 million tonnes), 2. India (206.60 million tonnes), 3. Bangladesh (58.61 million tonnes), 4. Indonesia (53.98 million tonnes) and 5. Vietnam (43.49 million tonnes). * According to latest updates – from FAO 2023, **Tajikistan** has the largest productivity of rice (9874.2 kg/ha) followed by **Australia** (9516.2 kg/ha). ***Wheat** is basically a temperate crop. Its cultivation spreads up to 60° latitudes in Northern Hemisphere and up to 40° latitudes in Southern Hemisphere. Wheat requires an average temperature of 10°C during germination and an average temperature between 15°-20°C during the development of grains. A Timely rainfall between 20 cm and 70 cm is also required. *According to FAO, 2023 the top **four leading producers of wheat** in the world are – China (136.59 million tonnes), India (110.55 million tonnes), Russia (91.50 million tonnes) and the USA (49.31 million tonnes). ***Sugarcane** requires a **subtropical climate** especially a monsoonal climate where the average temperature is between 21°C-27°C with average rainfall between 75 cm 150 cm. According to FAO 2023, the **top five leading producers of sugarcane** in the world are – 1. Brazil (782.59 million tonnes), 2. India (490.53 million tonnes), 3. China (104.57 million tonnes), 4. Thailand (93.98 million tonnes), 5. Pakistan (87.64 million tonnes). ***Sugar beet** is a plant of temperate climate. According to FAO 2023 the two largest producers of sugar beet in the world are Russia and the USA. Russia and the USA are followed by Germany, France and Turkiye. In Ukraine, the entire production of sugar is from sugar beet. ***Cotton** is a tropical and subtropical flora. Quality and type of cotton are determined by the length of the fibers, shine, etc. According to FAO 2022 the top 5 leading producers of cottonseed in the world are – 1. China (10.00 million tonnes), 2. India (9.70 million tonnes), 3. USA (4.01 million tonnes), 4. Brazil (3.72 million tonnes), 5. Turkiye (1.65 million tonnes), while the top 5 leading producers in terms of cotton lint are (FAO 2022) – 1. China (5.98 million tonnes), 2. India (5.29 million tonnes), 3. USA (3.15 million tonnes) 4. Brazil (2.47 million tonnes), 5. Australia (1.27 million tonnes). *According to FAO 2023,

India is the largest producer of **castor oil Seed**. India produces 1.98 million tonnes of castor oilseeds. India is followed by Mozambique (0.07 million tonnes), Brazil (0.04 million tonnes). *According to FAO 2023, the **top 5 leading producers of bananas** in the world are – India (36.61 million tonnes), China (11.70 million tonnes), Indonesia (9.33 million tonnes), Nigeria (7.31 million tonnes) and Ecuador (7.19 million tonnes). *According to FAO 2023, the **top 4 leading producers of coconut** (shell) in the world are – 1. Indonesia (17.97 million tonnes), 2. Philippines (14.89 million tonnes), 3. India (14.16 million tonnes) and 4. Brazil (2.89 million tonnes). ***Tobacco** cultivation requires high temperatures. It grows well between 21° to 27°C. Tobacco requires an annual average rainfall of 100 to 120 centimeters. According to FAO 2023, the **leading producers of tobacco** (unmanufacture) in the world are – (1) China (2.29 million tonnes), (2) India (0.77 million tonnes), (3) Brazil (0.68 million tonnes), (4) Indonesia (0.24 million tonnes) and (5) Zimbabwe (0.24 million tonnes). ***Rubber** is obtained from the **latex** of a tree found in the equatorial evergreen forests. Rubber trees are tropical trees that require a temperature of **25° to 30°** and an average annual rainfall of 150 to 200 cm. According to FAO 2023, the **top 5 leading producers of natural rubber** in the world are – 1. Thailand (4707.26 thousand tonnes), 2. Indonesia (2651.23 thousand tonnes), 3. Cote d'Ivoire (1548.00 thousand tonnes), 4. Vietnam (1270.29 thousand tonnes) and 5. China (864.77 thousand tonnes). *Coffee is a bush type of tree found in the tropical and subtropical regions. The **Abyssinian Plateau** (Ethiopia) is the native place of coffee. The main species of coffee are – (1) **Coffea Arabica** – It occupies 3/4 of the total coffee in the world. (2) **Coffea Robusta** – Grown on a large scale in Africa, in countries such as Ethiopia and Uganda. Robusta is grown in India. According to FAO 2023, the **leading producers of green coffee** in the world are – 1. Brazil (3405.27 thousand tonnes), 2. Vietnam (1956.78 thousand tonnes), 3. Indonesia (760.19 thousand tonnes), 4. Colombia (680.86 thousand tonnes), 5. Ethiopia (559.40 thousand tonnes), 6. Honduras (384.36 thousand tonnes), 7. Uganda (384.00 thousand tonnes), 8. Peru (369.55 thousand tonnes), 9. India (332.85 thousand tonnes). ***Tea** is a plant of the tropical and subtropical regions but can also be grown in the hilly areas of the temperate zones. Tea requires a long summer with an average temperature between 20°-30°C. Tea also requires average rainfall between 130 and 150 cm. *According to FAO

2023 China produces the maximum tea leaves (16000.00 thousand tonnes) in the world followed by India (6343.16 thousand tonnes), Kenya (2577.80 thousand tonnes), Sri Lanka (1433.54 thousand tonnes) and Turkiye (1356.56 thousand tonnes). *Tea was first used in China as a **medicinal drink**. Maize is the third most important grain after rice and wheat. It is native to Latin America. In Western cultures (mainly the U.S.A.), Maize is used as fodder for animals while in Latin America, it is consumed by people as food source. According to FAO 2023, the **top 6** leading producer of **Maize** (corn) in the world are – **1. USA** (389694.46 thousand tonnes), **2. China** (288842.30 thousand tonnes), **3. Brazil** (131950.25 thousand tonnes), **4. Argentina** (41409.45 thousand tonnes), **5. India** (38085.26 thousand tonnes), **6. Ukraine** (31030.44 thousand tonnes). ***Plantation agriculture** is mostly practiced in tropical regions. It is practiced on small pieces of land rather than in large estates. Every region has some specific crop growing in that place. *According to the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare plantation crops include- **Coconut, Cocoa, Arecanut and Chashew nuts**. However according to Ministry of Commerce and Industry plantation crops include – **Tea, Coffee, Rubber and Spices**. Hence, plantation agriculture includes – Coconut, Arecanut, Cocoa, Cashew nut, Tea, Coffee, Rubber and Spices. *Horticulture includes **Pomology** (Cultivation of Fruits), **Olericulture** (cultivation of Vegetables) and **Floriculture** (Cultivation of Flowers). Now, Mushrooms, Bamboo, Spices etc. have also been brought under the definition of Horticulture. Horticulture requires a lot of manual labor. Coffee cultivation is a horticultural practice in Hawaii (USA). The coffee of Hawaii is famously known as **Kona coffee**. **Mocha coffee** is produced in Yemen. Mocha is the name of the harbor from where it is imported. * The diverse climate of India ensures the production of a variety of vegetables and fruits. According to FAO, 2023 India is the largest producer of fruit (other fruit, n.e.c.), and second largest producer of vegetables (other vegetables, fresh n.e.c.) after China. *In **alley cropping**, crops are grown in the spaces left between the trees planted in rows. ***Taungya** is a type of shifting agriculture practised in Myanmar. **Chena, jhuming** and **milpa** are also associated with shifting agriculture. *The regions of Europe close to the Mediterranean Sea are famous for the **cultivation of grapes**. Around 85% of the total grapes produced are used for making wines. ***Sacramento-San Joaquin Valley** is located in

California (USA). Sacramento is a flat/internal valley, the where River San Joaquin creates an inland delta. The valley is world famous for grapes and citrus fruit. *Golden Crescent is the name given to the countries that produce and export **poppy**. Countries included in the Golden Crescent are Pakistan, Iran and Afghanistan. *Groundnuts are native to Brazil, Mato Grosso and its nearby areas. Groundnut is the main crop of Gambia and has a major role to play in the country's GDP (Gross Domestic Product). According to FAO, 2023 China is the largest producer of groundnuts excluding shelled in the world. **Catechu (kattha)** is obtained from the wood of Acacia catechu tree. First time in the world, American agronomist Norman Borlaug developed the high yielding variety (HYV) seeds in Mexico. According to the International Agreement on Agriculture, a **Green Box** is an instrument through which economic assistance is provided in the fields of – research related to control of insects and disease, training, general awareness, marketing and promotion activities. ***Shahtoosh** is a special woolen shawl made out of the hairs of Tibetan Antelope and Chiru. **Chiru** is found in the Chinese Autonomous Region of Tibet. Earlier it was also found in western Nepal. Chiru is also found in the union territory of Ladakh. Apiculture is associated with the rearing of honey bees for honey production. ***Viticulture** is associated with study and production of grapes. * According to FAO, 2022 China is the largest producer of **raw silk** in the world, followed by India. Other countries producing silk include Uzbekistan, Vietnam, Thailand and the Democratic People's Republic of Korea. *Nitrogen is an essential element for the development of plants. It is important for the development of plant cells and tissues hence a deficiency of nitrogen hampers the growth of plants causing the leaves to turn yellowish in colour and dry up. Rhizobium, Azotobacter, Azospirillum and blue-green algae are used as bio-fertilizers for crops. ***Blue-green algae** is used as a bio-fertilizer in paddy fields, whereas azotobacter is used as a bio-fertilizer for paddy wheat, maize, mustard, potato, cotton etc. Azospirillum is used as a bio-fertilizer for Paddy, Sorghum, Millet, Sugarcane, Maize etc. *Alfa-Alfa is a flowering plant of the Fabaceae pea family. It is cultivated as an important fodder crop. In the United Kingdom, Australia, South Africa and New Zealand, it is called Lucerne grass. *Animal husbandry is more developed in those regions where natural grazing lands or grasslands are found in abundance. The credit for commercializing animal husbandry is given to

European migrants. **Ranches** are large farms for cattle grazing. They are built by enclosing natural grasslands with barbed wire and then using them as grazing lands for livestock. Maximum livestock is found in Asia. According to FAO 2020, the **countries with maximum livestock population are** – China (829.58 million), India (545.33 million), Brazil (304.15 million), and USA (201.69 million). Western Europe, USA, Canada, Russia, Australia and New Zealand are important regions of dairy farming. According to the Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics, 2024 milk production in the country continues to increase as it is anticipated to be 239.30 million tonnes in 2023-24 with a per capita availability of milk at about 471 grams/day. According to World Food and Agriculture Statistical Yearbook, 2024 the top five leading producers (2022) of milk (bovine milk) in the world are – India (207.52 million tonnes), USA (102.72 million tonnes), Pakistan (60.55 million tonnes), China (38.97 million tonnes), and Brazil (35.65 million tonnes).

1. The leading producer of both wheat and rice in the world is :

- (a) China (b) India
(c) U.S.A. (d) France

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

According to the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO STAT) for 2023–

Wheat –

- (1) China – 136.59 million tonnes
(2) India – 110.55 million tonnes
(3) Russia – 91.50 million tonnes
(4) USA – 49.31 million tonnes

Rice –

- (1) China – 208.06 million tonnes
(2) India – 206.60 million tonnes
(3) Bangladesh – 58.61 million tonnes
(4) Indonesia – 53.98 million tonnes

2. India's rank in rice production in the world is:

- (a) First (b) Second
(c) Third (d) Fourth

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

According to FAO 2023, India is the second largest producer of rice.

3. Which of the following countries has the largest area under rice cultivation?

- (a) China (b) India
(c) Japan (d) Philippines

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

As per the FAO, 2023 data the area under rice cultivation for the given countries as follows –

(Country)	Area (in hectares)
India	- 47828000
China	- 29171100
Japan	- 1478300
Philippines	- 4815813

Therefore, as per data India has maximum area of Cultivation under rice.

4. Arrange the following countries in the descending order of their wheat production and select the correct answer from the code given below :

1. China 2. India
3. Russia 4. U.S.A.

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4 (b) 1, 2, 4, 3
(c) 2, 3, 4, 1 (d) 4, 1, 2, 3

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

Option (b) was the correct descending order of wheat producing countries when this question was asked. However, according to FAO data 2023, after China and India, Russia is the third largest producer of wheat and the USA is in fourth place. So, in present situation option (a) is correct.

5. The largest wheat producing country in the world is –

- (a) United States of America (b) India
(c) China (d) Canada

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

According to FAO 2023, China is the largest producer of wheat in the world.

6. Which of the following countries has the highest productivity of rice?

- (a) China (b) India
(c) Japan (d) Germany

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

The highest productivity of rice was in China when this question was asked. According to FAO- 2023 data, the largest production of rice per hectare in Tajikistan is 9874.2 kg/ha followed by Australia (9516.2 kg/ha). The production of rice per hectare in China 7132.5 kg/ha, in India 4322.3 kg/ha and in - Japan 6856.5 kg/ha.

7. The cultivation of hybrid rice is most popular in –

- (a) Japan (b) China
(c) Korea (d) India

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

The cultivation of hybrid rice is most popular in China. In China, hybrid rice is estimated to be cultivated on more than half of the rice-growing land.

8. The 'Rice Gene Bank' of the world is situated in –

- (a) China (b) Philippines
(c) Japan (d) India

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

The Rice Gene Bank is situated in the International Rice Research Institute in Los Banos, Philippines.

9. Which of the following countries accounts for about two-third of its export earnings from rice trade?

- (a) Japan (b) Thailand
(c) Myanmar (d) Indonesia

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (*)

According to data from FAO 2013,

Country	Total export value (in thousand Dollars)	Export price of rice	Rice share in total export
Japan	2987602	18153	0.60%
Myanmar	1338761	157910	11.79%
Thailand	31426858	4429582	14.09%
Indonesia	34455718	1193	0.00%

When the question was asked, the commission considered option (c) as correct.

According to FAO data 2023, the top exporting countries in terms of both quantity and value of rice are the U.S.A. and Brazil respectively.

10. World's largest producer of sugarcane is –

- (a) Brazil (b) China

(c) India

(d) Indonesia

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

Brazil is the largest producer of sugarcane. According to FAO data 2023, the leading producers of sugarcane are –

i. Brazil	782.59 million tonnes
ii. India	490.53 million tonnes
iii. China	104.57 million tonnes
iv. Thailand	93.98 million tonnes

11. Which one of the following countries is the second largest producer of sugarcane in the World?

- (a) Brazil (b) Cuba
(c) India (d) China

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

According to FAO 2023, India is the second largest producer of sugarcane in the world after Brazil.

12. Two largest producers of beets in the world are –

- (a) Belgium and China (b) France and Russia
(c) Germany and the U.S.A. (d) Turkey and Ukraine

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

When the question was asked option (b) was correct. According to data from FAO 2023, Russia and France are the largest producers of sugar beets in the world.

13. Which one of the following countries produces sugar from sugar-beets only ?

- (a) France (b) Ukraine
(c) Germany (d) Italy

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

Ukraine produces almost all of its sugar production from sugar beets only.

14. Which is the largest cotton producing country in the world?

- (a) India (b) Egypt
(c) USA (d) Russia

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

The leading producer of cotton in the world was the USA after China at the time when the question was asked. According to recent (2022) data from FAO, China is the largest cotton lint producer followed by the India, USA, Brazil and Australia.

15. Which of the following countries has the highest per hectare production (2014) of cotton in the world?

- (a) Israel (b) Mexico
(c) Pakistan (d) Australia

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

When the question was asked option (d) Australia was the correct answer. According to the latest update from FAO 2023, China has the largest productivity of cotton (seed cotton, unginned) (6635.2 kg/ha) followed by Mexico (4518.8 kg/ha) and Turkiye (4398.5 kg/ha).

16. The highest per acre yield of cotton among the following countries is recorded in:

- (a) U.S.A. (b) China
(c) Pakistan (d) India

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

When the question was asked option (b) China was the correct answer. According to the data from FAO 2023, largest cotton (seed cotton, unginned) productivity was 6635.2 kg/ha in China.

17. Which of the following countries is the largest producer exporter of castor-oilseeds ?

- (a) France (b) India
(c) Japan (d) China

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

When the question was asked option (b) was the correct answer. According to FAO 2023 data the largest producer and exporter (both in quantity and value) of castor oilseed is India.

18. The largest producer of bananas in the world is :

- (a) Columbia (b) Zimbabwe
(c) Malaysia (d) India

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

According to FAO data 2023, the largest producers of bananas in the world are –

1.	India	36614.00 thousand tonnes
2.	China	11702.80 thousand tonnes
3.	Indonesia	9335.23 thousand tonnes
4.	Nigeria	7308.10 thousand tonnes
5.	Ecuador	7198.48 thousand tonnes

19. The largest producer of coconut in the world is :

- (a) Brazil (b) India

(c) Indonesia

(d) Philistine

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

According to data of FAO 2023, the three leading producer of Coconut in the world are as follows:

	(Country)	(Coconut)
1.	Indonesia	17970.22 thousand tonnes
2.	Philippines	14892.63 thousand tonnes
3.	India	14163.00 thousand tonnes

20. To whom does the credit goes for the development of coconut and sugarcane agriculture in Philippines?

- (a) French
(b) Hollanders
(c) Britishers
(d) Spanish and Americans

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

The credit for the development of coconut and sugarcane agriculture in the Philippines goes to the Spanish and Americans.

21. What is the rank of India in the world as a fruit producer?

- (a) Third (b) Fourth
(c) First (d) Second

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

According to FAOSTAT 2023 India ranks first in the production of fruits (other fruits n.e.c.).

22. Which country in the world is the largest producer of tobacco?

- (a) China (b) India
(c) Pakistan (d) Bangladesh

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

According to FAO (2023), three largest producers of tobacco (unmanufactured) in the world are –

1.	China	2296.70 thousand tonnes
2.	India	769.67 thousand tonnes
3.	Brazil	683.47 thousand tonnes

23. Which of the following statements are correct:

- China is the largest producer of Tobacco in the world
- India is the largest producer of Jowar in the world
- Brazil is the largest producer of Soyabean in the world
- Italy is the largest producer of raw silk in the world

Code:

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

When this question was asked, China was the leading producer of tobacco & raw silk in the world. India was the leading producer of jowar (sorghum) in the world. The United States of America was the largest producer of Soybean in the world. According to 2023 FAO data China is the largest producer of tobacco (unmanufactured). Largest producer of sorghum is USA followed by Nigeria and Mexico. The largest producer of Soybeans is Brazil.

24. Which one of the following countries exports the highest percentage of its sugar production –

- (a) India (b) Mauritius
(c) Mexico (d) China

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (b)

In the given options, Mauritius exports the highest percentage of its sugar production. The economy of Mauritius mainly depends on sugar exports and tourism.

25. The largest producer of natural rubber in the world is :

- (a) Brazil (b) India
(c) Malaysia (d) Thailand

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

According to recent data from FAO 2023, the five leading producers of natural rubber in the world are as follows:

1. Thailand 4707.26 thousand tonnes
2. Indonesia 2651.24 thousand tonnes
3. Cote d' Ivoire 1548.00 thousand tonnes
4. Vietnam 1270.29 thousand tonnes

Thus, the correct answer is option (d).

26. Two major producers of natural rubber in the world are:

- (a) Brazil and Malaysia
(b) Vietnam and India
(c) China and Philippines
(d) Thailand and Indonesia

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

When the question was asked option (d) was correct answer. According to FAO 2023, the largest producer of natural rubber in the world is Thailand. After Thailand Indonesia follows.

27. About one-third of the world's production of natural rubber comes from

- (a) India (b) Indonesia
(c) Malaysia (d) Thailand

U.P.P.S.C (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (d)

According to FAO 2023, about one-third of the world's production of natural rubber comes from Thailand.

28. The largest rubber cultivation is done in –

- (a) India
(b) China
(c) Amazon and Zaire basins
(d) England

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

As per the given options 'India' is the correct answer, when the question was asked. According to recent data from FAO, 2023, the largest rubber production is done in Thailand, Indonesia and Cote d' Ivoire.

29. Coffee cultivation in Sri Lanka was abandoned because of the disease :

- (a) Leaf blight (b) Leaf spot
(c) Leaf Rust (d) Rot

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

Beginning in the decade of 1860s, due to the epidemic, called leaf rust (*Hemileia vastatrix*), the cultivation of coffee was abandoned in most of the British colonies. This epidemic started in Sri Lanka (South Asia) during the year 1869. *Hemileia vastatrix* is a fungus of the order Pucciniales that causes coffee leaf rust (CLR), a disease that is devastating to susceptible coffee plantations.

30. The two leading producers of coffee in the world are :

- (a) Brazil and Colombia (b) Brazil and Vietnam
(c) Mexico and India (d) Ethiopia and Mexico

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

According to data from FAO 2023 leading producers of coffee (green) in the world are as follows:

- (1) Brazil, (2) Vietnam, (3) Indonesia, (4) Colombia, (5) Ethiopia, (6) Honduras, (7) Uganda, (8) Peru, (9) India.

31. The highest coffee producing country in the world is :

- (a) Bolivia (b) Brazil
(c) China (d) India

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (b)

According to FAO, 2023 the top coffee (green) producing countries are:

- (1) Brazil (3405.27 thousand tonnes)
- (2) Vietnam (1956.78 thousand tonnes)
- (3) Indonesia (760.19 thousand tonnes)
- (4) Colombia (680.86 thousand tonnes)
- (5) Ethiopia (559.40 thousand tonnes)
- (6) Honduras (384.36 thousand tonnes)
- (7) Uganda (384.00 thousand tonnes)
- (8) Peru (369.55 thousand tonnes)
- (9) India (332.85 thousand tonnes)

32. The country at the top in terms of percentage of total coffee production in the world is

- (a) Colombia
- (b) Brazil
- (c) India
- (d) Ethiopia

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

According to FAO 2023, the country at the top in terms of percentage of total coffee production in the world is Brazil.

33. Which one of the following countries is the second largest exporter of coffee in the world?

- (a) Indonesia
- (b) Colombia
- (c) Vietnam
- (d) Brazil

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

According to FAO (2023), Vietnam is the second largest exporter of coffee in the world after Brazil (according to quantity).

34. Robusta is a variety of _____ produced in Africa.

- (a) Banana
- (b) Coffee
- (c) Tobacco
- (d) Cocoa

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Coffee Canephora (Coffea Robusta), commonly known as robusta coffee, is a variety of coffee that has its origins in Central and Western sub-Saharan Africa specifically Ethiopia and Uganda. Robusta coffee is also cultivated in India.

35. Which country exports the maximum quantity of tea?

- (a) Sri Lanka
- (b) China
- (c) Kenya
- (d) India

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

When the question was asked according to FAO 2004 data, Sri Lanka was the leading exporter in terms of quantity & value. As of 2023 the data prepared by FAO indicated that the leading exporter of tea leaves is Kenya (in quantity) and China (in value).

36. Which one of the following countries is the largest exporter of tea in the world?

- (a) India
- (b) China
- (c) Kenya
- (d) Sri Lanka

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

As per FAO data, when the question was asked (year 2015) quantity & value in China made it the biggest exporter. In the year 2023, Kenya is the largest exporter in quantity and China is the largest exporter in value.

37. Which of the following countries was the largest exporter (value in \$) of tea in the world in 2016-17?

- (a) Sri Lanka
- (b) India
- (c) China
- (d) Kenya

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

In the given options, China in the years 2017 and 2023 is the biggest tea exporter (in value dollars).

(Country)	(2017)	(2023)
1. China	1.6 Billion Dollar	1.74 Billion Dollar
2. Kenya	1.5 Billion Dollar	1.35 Billion Dollar
3. Sri Lanka	1.4 Billion Dollar	1.29 Billion Dollar
4. India	768.1 Million Dollar	0.71 Billion Dollar

38. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists –

List-I (Crop)	List-II (Production zone)
(A) Coffee	1. Prairies plains
(B) Jute	2. Yangtze plains
(C) Rice	3. Sao Paulo Plateau
(D) Wheat	4. Ganges delta

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	1	4	2
(b)	2	4	1	3
(c)	3	4	2	1
(d)	4	3	2	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

Ans. (c)

The correct combination of crops and concerned production zones are as follows:

(Crop)		(Production Zone)
Coffee	-	Sao Paulo Plateau
Jute	-	Ganges delta
Rice	-	Yangtze plains
Wheat	-	Prairies plains

39. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists—

List-I (Crop)	List-II (Production zone)
(A) Coffee	1. Yangzi Jiang basin
(B) Rice	2. Sao Paulo
(C) Wheat	3. Candy basin
(D) Tea	4. Huang He basin

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	1	4
(b)	2	1	4	3
(c)	4	2	1	3
(d)	3	1	4	2

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

Yangzi Jiang basin is known for rice production and Huang He basin is known for Winter Wheat production while coffee is cultivated in Sao Paulo region and Candy basin of Sri Lanka is prominent in tea production.

40. Match List - I with List - II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List - I	List - II
A. Cocoa	1. Ivory Coast
B. Coffee	2. Kenya
C. Tea	3. South Africa
D. Sugarcane	4. Ghana

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	1	4
(b)	4	1	2	3
(c)	1	4	3	2
(d)	2	3	4	1

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The correct combination of crops and concerned countries is as follows:

Cocoa	-	Ghana
Coffee	-	Ivory Coast
Tea	-	Kenya
Sugarcane	-	South Africa

41. Which of the following states of U.S.A. grows coffee?

- (a) Florida (b) California
(c) Hawaii (d) Arizona
(e) None of these

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

Coffee is grown in the state of Hawaii, United States of America. The most famous of Hawaiian coffees are known as Kona coffee.

42. Which fruit is not Tropical ?

- (a) Walnut (b) Coconut
(c) Apple (d) Cashew nut

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (c)

Apple is commercially cultivated in temperate and subtropical regions. So option (c) is correct. Flowers do not grow on apple trees in tropical regions because this process requires cold climatic conditions.

43. Large amount of labour is applied on small-sized holdings under the system of

- (a) Mediterranean Farming (b) Oriental Farming
(c) Commercial Farming (d) Commercial Horticulture

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

Fruits, spices, vegetables, shrubs, flowers and turf are cultivated under commercial horticulture. Tea, coffee, sugarcane, rubber etc. are also cultivated under commercial horticulture. Large amount of human labour is required in commercial horticulture compared to other agricultural practices as continuous supervision of commercial crops (tea, coffee etc) is an essential factor of commercial horticulture.

44. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below the Lists :

List-I (Crop)	List-II (Region/Country)
A. Rubber	1. Mauritius
B. Coffee	2. Italy

- C. Olive
D. Sugarcane
3. Colombia
4. Malaysia
- Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	4	3	1	2
(d)	3	4	2	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

The correct combination of crops and concerned production countries is as follows:

(Crop)	(Region/Country)
Rubber	– Malaysia
Coffee	– Colombia
Olive	– Italy
Sugarcane	– Mauritius

45. Match List-I and List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the list:

List-I (Leading Producer Country)	List-II (Commodity)
A. China	1. Natural Rubber
B. India	2. Milk
C. Saudi Arabia	3. Iron-Ore
D. Thailand	4. Petroleum

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	3	2	4	1
(d)	2	3	1	4

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

The correct combination of commodity and leading producer country is as follows:

(Country)	(Commodity)
China [Now Australia (2022)]	– Iron - Ore
India	– Milk
Saudi Arabia [Now USA (2022)]	– Petroleum
Thailand	– Natural Rubber

Thus, the correct answer is option (c).

46. Consider the following statements associated with Plantation agriculture and select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- Mostly Tropical plantations are located in lowlands.
- Tropical plantations are found in bunches along the sea coast.
- Favorable physical conditions for Rubber plantation occur in Amazon Basin but lacks workers.

Code :

- 1 & 2 are correct
- 2&3 are correct
- 1 & 3 are correct
- All statements are correct.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

The tropical plantation is one of the world's oldest systems of commercial agriculture. Plantation crops are usually raised on large estates, of more than 40 hectares (100 acres) each, though the success of such crops has often encouraged other farmers to grow them so small holdings also exist side by side with the large estates. It is always a monoculture over a large area, e.g., coffee in Brazil, tea in India, rubber in Malaysia, etc. Some of the main plantation crops are rubber, palm oil, cotton and copra, beverages like coffee, tea and cocoa, Fruits like pineapples and bananas, as well as sugarcane, hemp and jute. Although these crops require heavy rainfall for their growth, stagnant water is injurious to their roots. It is, therefore, grown on hill slopes where water drains away easily and waterlogging does not take place. However, it grows equally well in the valley if the drainage is good. Thus, statement (1) is wrong but statement (2) is correct. Until the 19th century, Amazon Basin was a major producer of natural rubber. Favorable conditions for rubber plantations existed in the Amazon Basin and rubber plants even grow spontaneously. Now, rubber production is not salient characteristic of South American countries because of the lack of workers and many other reasons. Thus, statement (3) is correct.

47. Consider the following crops :

- Coffee
- Rubber
- Coconut
- Spices

Which of the above crops are plantation crops ?

- 1 and 4
- 1, 2 and 3
- 3 and 4
- 1, 2 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (*)

According to the Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, coconut, arecanut, cocoa and cashew nut come under plantation crops. However, as per the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, tea, coffee, rubber and spices are plantation crops. Thus, coconut, arecanut, cocoa, cashew nut, tea, coffee, rubber and spices are plantation crops.

48. A cropping system where crops are grown in the inter spaces between rows of planted trees is called

- (a) Relay cropping (b) Mixed cropping
(c) Inter-cropping (d) Alley cropping

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

Alley cropping is planting rows of trees with wide spacings. A companion crop is grown in the alleyways between the rows. Intercropping is a wide range of multiple cropping practices involving growing two or more crops in proximity which includes relay cropping, mixed cropping and alley cropping methods.

49. 'Monoculture' is a distinct characteristic of –

- (a) Commercial grain-farming
(b) Shifting cultivation
(c) Subsistence farming
(d) Organic farming

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Monoculture is a distinct characteristic of commercial grain farming.

50. Which one of the following is not a type of shifting cultivation ?

- (a) Chena (b) Jhooming
(c) Milpa (d) Fazenda

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006, 2010

Ans. (d)

Jhooming, Chena and Milpa are types of shifting cultivation while Fazenda is not concerned with shifting cultivation. Fazenda is related to plantations found throughout Brazil.

51. 'Taungya' agriculture is practised in :

- (a) Myanmar (b) Japan
(c) New Zealand (d) Philippines

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Taungya is a system whereby villagers and sometimes forest plantation workers are given the right to cultivate agricultural crops during the early stage of the forest. It is mainly practised in Myanmar.

52. With reference to primitive subsistence agricultural practices, which of the pair/s is/are correctly matched?

Agricultural Practices	Region
1. Jhumming	: South-East Asia
2. Milpa	: Mexico
3. Ladang	: Sri Lanka

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

Code :

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Primitive subsistence agricultural practices :

Jhumming - South East Asia

Milpa - Mexico and Central America

Ladang - Indonesia

Hence statements 1 and 2 are correct. Primitive subsistence agricultural practices are also called slash and burn farming methods, which are prevalent in many tribes of the world including India.

53. Assertion (A) : A plant which has Nitrogen deficiency will show symptoms like stunted growth and pale green and yellow leaves.

Reason (R) : Nitrogen is responsible for green leaf growth.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are individually true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are individually true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Nitrogen is an essential element for the growth and development of plants. It is a major constituent for the formation of cells and tissues. Due to a lack of nitrogen, the development of plants is blocked. The chlorophyll content of the plant leaves is reduced which results in a pale yellow color. Older leaves turn completely yellow. Flowering, fruiting, protein and starch contents are reduced. A reduction in protein results in stunted growth and dormant lateral buds.

54. Consider the following organisms :

1. Agaricus 2. Nostoc
3. Spirogyra

Which of the above is/are used as biofertilizer/ fertilizers?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) Only 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) Only 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Azotobacter, Rhizobium, Azospirillum and blue-green algae have been being used as biofertilizers for a long time. Blue-green algae belonging to the genus cyanobacteria such as, Nostoc Anabaena Tolypothrix or Aulosira, fix atmospheric nitrogen and are used as inoculations for paddy crops grown in both upland and lowland conditions.

55. Azolla- Anabaena Biofertilizer is used for crop :

- (a) Wheat (b) Rice
(c) Mustard (d) Cotton

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Azolla- Anabaena Biofertilizer is used for rice crop production.

56. Which one of the following is used as a bio-fertilizer?

- (a) Neem (b) Azolla
(c) Urea (d) Potassium

Uttarakhand Lower Sub. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

57. Blue Green Algae is used as biofertilizer to induce which of the following crop production ?

- (a) Wheat (b) Rice
(c) Gram (d) Mustard

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Blue Green Algae is used as biofertilizer to induce paddy crop production.

58. 'Alfalfa' is :

- (a) A kind of grass (b) A tribe
(c) An animal (d) A town

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Alfalfa (Medicago sativa) is a plant primarily native to Asia, and is considered to be one of the first known herbs to mankind. It is naturally high in many essential vitamins and minerals, including A,C,E,K and family of B-vitamins; biotin, calcium, folic acid, iron, Magnesium, Potassium etc.

59. Assertion (A) : There are no tea plantations in any African country.

Reason (R) : Tea Plants need fertile soil with high humus.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are individually true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are individually true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (d)

For the first time, tea was produced in Africa at the 'Durban Botanical Garden' in the year 1850. Until the Second World War, appx. 800 hectares of land were used for the cultivation of tea in Africa. In the 20th century, Kenya, Tanzania and Uganda became major tea producers. Hence it is not correct to say that Africa is not related to tea plantations. Tea plantations need well-drained hill slopes, fertile soil with rich humus. Hence, reason (R) is correct.

60. What is Podzol ?

- (a) Soil found in Coniferous forest region
(b) Soil of arid region
(c) Very fertile alluvial soil
(d) None of the above

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

Podzol soil is found near 60° North latitudes in Eurasia and North America's coniferous forest of the Taiga region.

61. 'Mocha' coffee is grown in:

- (a) Iraq (b) Brazil
(c) Argentina (d) Yemen

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Mocha coffee is grown in Yemen. Café mocha takes its name from Mocha seaport from where it was exported.

62. Which one of the following is not found in Tea?

- (a) Theanine (b) Caffeine
(c) Tannin (d) Morphine

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Tea was first used as a medicinal drink in China. Theanine, caffeine, polyphenols, tannin, theobromine, theophylline, etc are found in tea while morphine is not found in tea.

63. Under the international agreement on agriculture the Green Box includes economic assistance for

1. Agricultural Research
2. Fertilizer
3. Irrigation
4. Plant Protection

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes :

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 | (b) 2 and 3 |
| (c) 3 and 4 | (d) 1 and 4 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (d)

The Green Box provides for the continuation (and enhancement) of programs such as research, including general research, research in connection with environmental programs, and research programs relating to particular products; pest and disease control programs, agricultural training services extension and advisory services; inspection services, marketing and promotion services.

64. Which one of the following is not a correct statement ?

- (a) Cocoa cultivation is popular in Ghana
- (b) Coffee is an important plantation crop of Brazil.
- (c) Sri Lanka is famous for the production of tea.
- (d) Sugarcane is the major plantation crop of Malaysia.

U.P. Lower Spl. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Cocoa in Ghana, coffee in Brazil and tea in Sri Lanka are famous plantation crops, while rubber is a major plantation crop of Malaysia.

65. Heroin is obtained from:

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| (a) Hemp | (b) Opium |
| (c) Tobacco | (d) Betelnut |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

Heroin is obtained from opium resin.

66. Which of the following countries are included in the "Golden Crescent" ?

- | | |
|----------------|-------------|
| 1. Afghanistan | 2. Iran |
| 3. Iraq | 4. Pakistan |

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

Code :

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 | (b) 3 and 4 |
| (c) 1, 2 and 3 | (d) 1, 2 and 4 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

The Golden Crescent is the name given to one of Asia's two principal areas of illicit opium production located in Central and South Asia. Golden Crescent includes three nations, Afghanistan, Iran, and Pakistan, whose mountainous peripheries define the crescent. Iraq is not included in this Golden Crescent.

67. In which of the following group of countries maize is used as staple food ?

- | | |
|--------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Western Europe | (b) Russia |
| (c) Middle Africa | (d) South-East Asia |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

Maize or corn is a cereal crop that is grown widely throughout the world. The grain is rich in vitamins (A, C, and E), carbohydrates, minerals and protein. It is also rich in dietary fiber. It is an important staple food for people in Middle Africa.

68. Sacramento- San Joaquin Valley, renowned for vitreous & citrus fruit production in America, is located at :

- | | |
|----------------|--------------|
| (a) California | (b) Alaska |
| (c) Mexico | (d) Columbia |

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (a)

Sacramento- San Joaquin Valley is located in California. The **San Joaquin Valley** is the area of the Central Valley of the U.S. state of California that lies south of the Sacramento-San Joaquin River Delta and is drained by the San Joaquin River. Sacramento- San Joaquin Valley is famous for vitreous & citrus fruit production in the world.

69. Assertion (A) : Commercial Viticulture is specific to the Mediterranean Region of Europe.

Reason (R) : 85% of its grapes go to wine making.

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

Commercial Viticulture is specific to the Mediterranean region of Europe. The major cause of viticulture on a large scale is the use of its grape production in wine.

70. Which of the following regions of the world, the production of citrus fruits is well developed?

- (a) Monsoon regions
- (b) Tropical high lands regions
- (c) Mediterranean regions
- (d) Equatorial regions

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

The production of citrus fruits is high in the Mediterranean regions. The Mediterranean climate region is also known as the subtropical dry-summer climate region.

71. In which one of the following countries high yielding variety seed was developed for the first time ?

- (a) Argentina
- (b) China
- (c) Mexico
- (d) India

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

American (USA) agronomist Norman. E. Borlaug developed high yielding variety seeds in Mexico for the first time.

72. The Wood of which tree is used for catechu production?

- (a) Saal
- (b) Khair
- (c) Babool
- (d) Saaja

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

Catechu is obtained from the wood of Khair tree (Acacia catechu).

73. Peanuts are the main crop of :

- (a) Georgia
- (b) Gambia
- (c) Ghana
- (d) Guatemala

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

Peanuts/Groundnut is the main crop of Gambia among the given countries. Presently, Ghana is the leading producer of groundnuts among the countries listed in the options. According to FAO, 2023 data China is the largest producer of groundnuts, excluding shelled globally.

74. The native place of groundnut is :

- (a) Australia
- (b) Brazil
- (c) China
- (d) South Africa

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

Brazil, Mato Grosso and its nearby areas in South America is considered the native place of groundnuts.

75. Most attractive, warmest and lightest wool of the world 'Shahtoosh' is produced in–

- (a) Nepal
- (b) Uzbekistan
- (c) China
- (d) Bangladesh

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Shahtoosh is the name given to a specific kind of shawl, which is woven with hair of the Tibetan antelope (Chiru) by master craftsmen. They are found almost entirely in China, Tibet, Southern Xinjiang, and Western Qinghai; a few are also found across the border in Ladakh, India. Thus, the correct option is (c).

76. Shahtoosh shawl is made from the hairs of -

- (a) Hangul
- (b) Chinkara
- (c) Chiru
- (d) Merino

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

77. Apiculture is the scientific method related to the production of :

- (a) Honey
- (b) Silk
- (c) Apple
- (d) Lac

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Apiculture is the maintenance of bees also called beekeeping. Thus, apiculture is related to the production of honey.

78. What is viticulture?

- (a) Protection of forests
- (b) Production of grapes
- (c) Type of primitive agriculture
- (d) Production of sugarcane

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Viticulture (from the Latin word for vine) is the science of production, and study of grapes. It deals with the series of events that occur in the vineyard. When the grapes are used for winemaking, it is also known as viniculture. It is a branch of the science of horticulture.

79. Which of the following is not correctly matched ?

- | Cultivation | Nomenclature of cultivation |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| (a) Flower's Cultivation | Floriculture |
| (b) Crops Cultivation | Agronomy |
| (c) Vegetables Cultivation | Horticulture |
| (d) Fruits Cultivation | Pomology |

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Vegetable cultivation is called Olericulture, not Horticulture. Rest are correctly matched.

80. What is the rank of India in silk production in the world?

- (a) First (b) Second
(c) Third (d) Fourth

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

According to FAO in the year 2022, India ranks second in the production of raw silk. The largest producer of raw silk in the world is China followed by India.

81. The country, which is the largest silk producer in the world is :

- (a) India (b) China
(c) Brazil (d) Japan
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

According to FAO 2022, China is the largest producer of raw silk in the world.

82. Assertion (A) : In Australia, cattle rearing is done more for meat than for milk.

Reason (R) : Australian are traditionally non-vegetarians.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

There are a total of 24.39 million cattle (2022) in Australia, 2 million (about) of them are used for dairy purposes while the rest are used for meat. Australia is among the top exporters of beef. The socio-cultural structure of Australian society indicates that they are traditionally non-vegetarians. Hence, both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

83. Which one amongst the following has the largest livestock population in the world?

- (a) Brazil (b) China
(c) India (d) USA

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Livestock population (in millions) for the given options, according to FAO statistics.

(Country)	(2007)	(2020)
Brazil	272.69	304.15
China	847.63	829.58
India	539.79	545.33
USA	182.53	201.69

So the answer to this question will be option (b) China.

84. Which of the following has destroyed the image of 'beef as a safe and healthy food in Europe and America?

- (a) Bird flu disease
(b) Mad cow disease
(c) Methods used in Pig farming
(d) Poultry practices

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

Mad cow disease first broke out in 1986 in U.K. It badly affected the British beef industry. Similar instances were also observed in North American countries.

85. The leading producer of milk in the world is :

- (a) China (b) India
(c) USA (d) Australia

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

U.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

Ans. (b)

According to the National Dairy Development Board India is the leading milk producer with a production of 239.3 million tonnes in 2023-24. Per capita milk availability in India is 471 grams per day (NDDB, 2023-24). According to World Food and Agriculture Statistical Yearbook, 2024 (2022 data), the milk producing countries are India, USA, Pakistan, China and Brazil respectively.

86. The largest Milk producing country in the world is :

- (a) Canada (b) Denmark
(c) England (d) India

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

87. Which of the following countries has the maximum production of milk per cow?

- (a) Netherlands (b) Great Britain
(c) Denmark (d) India

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Option (c) was the correct answer in the question period. According to FAO data for the year 2020, the average annual production of milk (Milk, whole fresh cow) per cow in the given countries is as follows :

Country	Production (Hectogram/ Cow)
Netherlands	92556
Great Britain (Including Northern Ireland)	83690
Denmark	100283
India	17030

Israel (127001 Hg/An) has the highest average annual production of milk during the above period.

88. The correct descending order of the leading producers of milk is:

- (a) China, India, Russia, U.S.A
- (b) India, U.S.A China, Russia
- (c) U.S.A., India, China, Russia
- (d) India, China, U.S.A., Russia

U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

The correct descending order of the leading milk producers (2011) is– India, U.S.A., China, Russia. According to the World Food and Agriculture Statistical Yearbook, 2024 the top 5 milk (bovine milk) producers are 1. India, 2. USA, 3. Pakistan, 4. China, 5. Brazil.

89. Which one of the following countries ranks second in the production of Corn in the world ?

- (a) Brazil
- (b) Mexico
- (c) Argentina
- (d) China

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (d)

When the question was asked option (d) was correct answer. According to FAO data 2023, three leading producers of maize corn in the world are :

Country		Production (thousand tonnes)
USA	-	389694.46
China	-	288842.30
Brazil	-	131950.25

90. Which one of the following is called the 'Sugar Bowl' of the world ?

- (a) Hawai Islands
- (b) Cuba
- (c) India
- (d) Philippines

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013, 2015

Ans. (b)

Cuba is known as the sugar bowl of the world because sugarcane is the major produce of Cuba which is used in the processing of sugar.

91. Large coffee plantations in Brazil are called

- (a) Estate
- (b) Estancias
- (c) Kalkhozes
- (d) Fazendas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

Fazenda is a type of plantation found in Brazil where coffee is produced in southeastern regions of Brazil. Fazendas were concentrated primarily in the northeastern region during the colonial period (16th-19th centuries) where sugar was produced.

92. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I (Country)	List-II (Principal Primary Export)
A. Chad	1. Cotton
B. Niger	2. Uranium
C. Rwanda	3. Petroleum
D. Benin	4. Coffee
Code :	
A B C D	
(a) 4 1 3 2	
(b) 2 4 1 3	
(c) 3 2 4 1	
(d) 1 3 2 4	

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

(Country)	(Principal Primary Export)
Chad	Petroleum
Niger	Uranium
Rwanda	Coffee
Benin	Cotton

93. Among the following, which one is the largest exporter of rice in the world in the last five years?

- (a) China
- (b) India
- (c) Myanmar
- (d) Vietnam

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

According to FAO statistics till the year 2013-23, India is the largest exporter of rice (milled) in the world in terms of quantity and value. Note that the figures for the year 2014 from FAO are not available. Hence, according to the question the correct option is (b).

94. Among the following countries, which one is the largest producer of saffron in the world?

- (a) Spain
- (b) Greece
- (c) New Zealand
- (d) Iran
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Iran is the largest producer (2024) of saffron in the world.

95. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below :

List - I (Economic Activity/ Agricultural region)	List - II (Country)
A. Commercial dairy farming	1. Argentina
B. Commercial grain farming	2. France
C. Commercial plantation farming	3. Denmark
D. Commercial fruits production	4. Malaysia

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	1	4	2
(b)	1	2	3	4
(c)	4	3	2	1
(d)	2	4	1	3

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The correct match is as follows :	
Economic Activity / Agricultural region	Country
Commercial dairy farming	Denmark
Commercial grain farming	Argentina
Commercial plantation farming	Malaysia
Commercial fruits production	France

96. Which one of the following is NOT a major Coco producer country?

- (a) Latvia (b) Cameroon
(c) Ghana (d) Ivory Coast

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Cocoa beans are produced from the cocoa tree, which is dried to make chocolate. Apart from this, its oil is also used for applying to the skin and hair and for cooking. According to FAO data 2023 Cote d'Ivoire, Ghana and Indonesia are at the top of the 3 largest producers of cocoa beans in the world. Cameroon is also 6th major producer of cocoa. Alternatively, Latvia is a country that produces less cocoa.

97. Which of the following countries are well known as the two largest cocoa producers in the world?

- (a) Algeria and Morocco
(b) Botswana and Namibia
(c) Cote d'Ivoire and Ghana
(d) Madagascar and Mozambique

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

Cocoa beans are generally produced in tropical zones around the equator, where climate conditions are well suited for growing cocoa trees. Cote d'Ivoire (Ivory Coast) and Ghana are well known as the two largest cocoa producers in the world. According to FAO data the top 5 cocoa bean producing countries in the world in 2023 are as follows: 1. Cote d'Ivoire (2377442.05 tonnes), 2. Ghana (653700 tonnes), 3. Indonesia (641741.02 tonnes), 4. Ecuador (375719.14 tonnes), 5. Brazil (296145 tonnes).

98. Consider the following statements -

- India has more arable area than China.
- The proportion of irrigated area is more in Indian as compared to China.
- The average productivity per hectare in India agriculture is higher than that in China.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) All three (d) None

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Arable land is a type of land that can be used for growing crops. This land is a significant indicator of any country's agricultural potential as well as food security. Significantly, India has about 154.45 million hectares of arable land as per FAOSTAT 2022. China has about 108.5 million hectares of arable land. Notably, India has more arable land than China and hence, statement 1 is correct. At present the proportion of irrigated area in India is less than in China. So statement 2 is incorrect. While talking about productivity, it can be measured by the yield per unit area of land, which is the amount of crop produced per hectare/acre. The average productivity per hectare in Indian agriculture is higher than that in China. Thus, statement 3 is not correct.

99. Consider the following statements with reference to-cultivated area of some countries of the world:

- In comparison to USA, China and Japan, India has highest geographical area under cultivation.
- India's location in tropical monsoon region helps diversified cropping all through the year.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Both 1 and 2 (b) Neither 1 nor 2
(c) Only 1 (d) Only 2

UPPSC (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

According to FAO data for the year 2022, the cropland area in India is 168.05 million hectares, while the cropland areas of United States of America, China and Japan are 154.7 million hectares, 127.58 million hectares and 4.33 million hectares, respectively. Latitudinally, India is situated in both the tropical and subtropical zones. However, in terms of climate, India falls under the tropical monsoon climate region due to this, diversified crop production occurs throughout the year in India. Therefore, both statements are correct.

100. What does the term "Cereale Yield" refer to?

- The amount of cereal crops produced per unit area of harvested land
- The total production of cereal crops in a given country

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both 1 and 2 (b) Neither 1 nor 2